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MS Office standalone again

Microsoft will release a standalone version of Office, which won't be part of Office 365. <http://dgit.in/oct20-68>

Jabra Elite 45H

Value for money purchase that gives you little to complain about

Danish company, Jabra, has steadily secured a respectable position in the consumer audio industry. The company recently launched the Elite 45H, a pair of supra-aural cans that revitalise the category. So, how do these cans perform in real-life? Read on to find out.

Build and comfort

The Jabra Elite 45H are not just lightweight but also comfortable on-ear headphones with a minimalist and classy look. Although the headphones are primarily made out of plastic, they don't look cheap at all. The rubberised headband and the ear cups, that employ the memory foam and PU leatherette covering combo, are pretty comfortable, overall. However, we did face some issues with the clamping force. Even on the tightest setting, the earcups were unable to exert adequate clamping pressure which inadvertently led to the cans sliding off, even if we tilted our head just a bit.

Coming to controls and ports, everything is placed on the right ear cup. There's a slider button which can be used to power off, power on, and turn on Bluetooth pairing. Next to it, there's a USB-C charging port. On the top, there's a three-button array which allows for media and call controls. There's also a solo button to summon your device's voice assistant. Overall, the buttons are fairly easy to find, and have a satisfying tactility to them.

Features

Unlike premium cans, these relatively affordable on-ear headphones provide users with a select few features. However, we did miss features such as an IP rating and high-quality codec



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VALUE	77



Price
₹9,999

support (AAC and aptX). Still, you do get access to the Jabra Sound+ app and voice assistant support with these cans. The Jabra Sound+ app comes with nifty functions such as

a five-band customisable EQ, music presets, and even customisable presets. There's also a MySound feature that tailors the equaliser to your hearing.

Coming to battery life, the headset features a massive playtime of 50 hours and Fast Charging abilities, where 15 minutes of charging nets you 10 hours of juice. In our tests that lasted over a week, we were unable to drain the battery completely, which is seriously impressive.

Performance

Sporting a lively and energetic sonic signature, the Jabra Elite 45H are possibly one of the best sounding mid-range supra-aural headphones on the market right now. There's ample vigour and drive across the board and most genres sound fantastic on the headphones. The mids seem to be the most prominent frequency, however, that doesn't take away from the almost equally lively lows and highs. For most tracks, the bass response is punchy and

pretty detailed even. In *Mindstreet* by *Motherjane*, the bass guitar flourishes doesn't take away from the clarity of the vocals and other instruments.

The cans are also excellent at handling vocal-centric tracks. The mids and high-mids soar elegantly in most scenarios with little to no sibilance.

The highs, while pretty detailed, can get a bit chaotic and aggressive due to the lively sonic signature which pushes the high-frequency instruments such as cymbals aggressively in some tracks.

Now, coming to the microphone, Jabra employs a two-mic array which does a great job at calls and even recording voice notes. In calls, the receiver could hear our voice distinctly without it sounding muffled and distant. The microphone intelligibility is also good, with the notes app picking up most of what we said accurately.

Bottomline

At ₹9,999 (and ₹8,999 on Amazon as of writing this review), the Jabra Elite 45H are one of the easiest on-ear headphones to recommend in this price range. Not only do you get a stellar battery life of about 50 hours, but you also get solid sound quality, good microphone performance, a comfortable design, and access to the nifty Jabra Sound+ app with a five-band EQ and music presets. At under 10K, the Jabra Elite 45H gives you very little to complain about and they're a solid pair of headphones in almost all aspects. If you do want ANC, however, you can consider the Sennheiser HD 450BT which costs about 5K more.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

SPEAKER SIZE: 40 mm | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20 Hz to 20 kHz | NUMBER OF MICROPHONES: 2 x MEMS | FORM FACTOR: On-ear headphone | EAR CUSHIONS PADDING MATERIAL: Memory foam | MUSIC AND TALK-TIME BATTERY LIFE: Up to 50 hours | FAST CHARGE: Up to 10 hours after charging the headphone for 15 minutes | CHARGING TIME: 1 hour and 30 minutes | CHARGING PLUG: USB-C | BLUETOOTH COMPLIANCE: Bluetooth 5.0 | OPERATING RANGE: Up to 10m/33 feet | PAIRED DEVICES: Up to 8 | MULTI-CONNECT: Two devices can be connected at the same time | WEIGHT (HEADPHONES): 160 g

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